

Jason Coelho

Visual Merchandising and Retail Operations Leader

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South African and US Citizen | Open to relocation

PROFILE

Visual merchandising and retail operations leader with close to a decade of experience managing VM strategy, space planning, store openings, brand standards, and VM upskilling across a multi-door retail and wholesale network at Brunello Cucinelli in the United States. Experienced in cross-functional collaboration with global VM, retail design, marketing, and operations teams to deliver compelling consumer journeys and commercial results. Brings a buying background that strengthens commercial decision-making within VM and space planning functions. South African citizen with deep knowledge of the local and African market, combined with extensive global retail experience across the US and Europe.

EXPERIENCE

Account Executive

Flagship.ai | Los Angeles, CA | May 2025 to November 2025

- One of the first US hires for a visual merchandising SaaS platform built for retail brands.
- Owned full sales cycle including HubSpot campaigns, discovery calls, and product demonstrations to 50 plus prospects.
- Built pipeline and closed 2 pilot programmes within first 4 months.

Regional Visual Merchandising Manager, West Coast

Suitsupply | Los Angeles, CA | June 2023 to May 2025

- Managed visual merchandising strategy and brand standards across 6 West Coast retail stores with weekly travel.
- Led floor planning, space planning, product presentation, and seasonal installations across the store network.
- Delivered VM upskilling and training to 30 plus store staff on VM execution and brand standards.
- Travelled to Amsterdam HQ and Italy for collection styling, trend alignment, and space planning review.
- Partnered cross-functionally with buying, operations, and marketing teams to support seasonal launches.

West Coast Regional Visual Merchandising Manager

Brunello Cucinelli | Los Angeles, CA | September 2019 to March 2022

- Managed VM strategy, brand standards, and seasonal installations across 13 retail locations and 25 wholesale accounts including Nordstrom, Saks Fifth Avenue, and Neiman Marcus.
- Led 4 store openings and store remodels end to end including space planning, fixture coordination, visual direction, and launch execution.
- Delivered VM training and upskilling to store teams across the West Coast network.
- Managed VM standards across wholesale doors, ensuring brand alignment across third-party retail environments.
- Partnered with Global Visual Direction and Retail Design teams to translate seasonal creative direction into market-specific consumer journeys.
- Led VIP showroom events and brand activations across the West Coast market.
- Travelled to Florence and Milan each season for collection styling, trend alignment, and space planning review.

Men's Buyer

Brunello Cucinelli | New York, NY | July 2014 to September 2019

- Co-managed men's collection buying across 12 US boutiques, building seasonal assortments aligned with brand strategy and commercial KPIs.
- Directed seasonal buying, product allocation, and 20 plus trunk shows annually across the US market.
- Supported 5 new store openings including space planning input, product allocation, and VM coordination.
- Managed OTB budgets and tracked sell-through performance across the US retail network.

- Travelled to Brunello Cucinelli HQ in Solomeo, Italy for seasonal collection previews, trend alignment, and product training.
- Built PR product-matching tool that increased editorial placements for the brand.
- Partnered cross-functionally with VM, marketing, operations, and finance teams to support seasonal launches.

Junior Buyer and Assistant General Manager

Suitsupply | Washington DC and Amsterdam, Netherlands | August 2012 to June 2014

- Promoted twice in under two years, progressing from retail sales to buying training at Amsterdam HQ.
- Managed product allocation across US and Canada store network.
- Supported new store openings in Toronto and Scottsdale including VM execution and product setup.
- Achieved over 1 million USD in personal client sales as Assistant General Manager.

CORE SKILLS AND COMPETENCIES

- Visual Merchandising Strategy and Execution
- Space Planning and Store Development
- Store Openings and Store Remodels
- Multi-Door Network Management
- VM Standards and Brand Standards
- VM Training and Team Upskilling
- Cross-Functional Team Leadership
- Stakeholder Management
- Consumer Journey Design
- Seasonal Installation and Brand Activation
- Retail Design Partnership
- Fashion Buying and Assortment Planning
- Open-to-Buy and Sell-Through Management
- Wholesale Partner and Account Management
- Commercial KPI Tracking and Reporting
- Emerging Markets Retail Knowledge

EDUCATION

BBA, Intrapreneurial Management

University of Johannesburg, South Africa

BFA, Graphic Design (incomplete)

Full Sail University, Florida, USA

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Citizenship: South African and United States citizen. Open to relocation.

Languages: English (native). Basic Afrikaans.

Interests: Road cycling, running, graphic design, film.